

Sermon of Drowned Radiance: On Sorrow, Oaths, and the Unburied Dead

Hear me, ash-marked faithful, and let no bright lie pass your lips.

The War of Drowned Light began in **225 AS** and ended in **235 AS**. **64617 casualties** were counted beneath its broken banners. Yet the counting did not end the war. The conflict collapsed into a decade of guerrilla reprisals, where every silence hid a knife and every road remembered vengeance. The Silent Choir is recorded as the victor—but victory is a bitter word when the war's spark was secretly staged by them.

Thus was drowned radiance made: light beneath black water, banners torn before they could proclaim triumph. Remember this when some lord praises the clean edge of a victory. There are wars that end only in ink. There are victories that leave the dead standing in the hearts of the living.

Look, then, upon **Corvus Hollowmere the Pale**, the Spymaster. Corvus was born in **351 AS**, and bears the pallor of one who serves secrets more faithfully than daylight. Their hidden oath to the Silent Choir is not shouted from a tower. It is kept beneath the tongue, where an oath becomes a chain. I say this not to condemn the keeping of silence—for silence may preserve a life—but because every concealed vow casts a shadow, and shadows gather where treachery has been fed.

And consider **Morwenna Vosgard**, the Sapper, born in **296 AS**. No physical features are recorded for her, and no temperament is recorded either. Perhaps that is fitting. The Sapper is known by the work left behind: earth broken, stone opened, foundations made uncertain. Let no soul imagine that only famous faces shape an age. Hands without songs may still alter the ground beneath every throne.

Before us stands the **Gauntlet of Sorrowfell**, regalia of grim authority. Its attunement cost is **12**. I proclaim that it was forged in **360 AS**. Wear it, if you must, as one wears judgment—not as a prize, but as a burden. Sorrow is not weakness. Sorrow is the weight that keeps the hand from becoming eager.

So kneel, but do not kneel blindly. Mourn, but do not let mourning become permission. The drowned dead have no mouths, yet their silence accuses every oath sworn in secret and every banner raised over ashes.

Let the Choir keep its victory. Let the Pale Spymaster keep their hidden vow. Let the Sapper's buried work remain beneath our feet.

We shall remember. And remembrance, though dim, is a blade that does not rust.